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SEO x PR

Press Releases for SEO? Read This First

Straight from Google

Raise It With Press Release

swipe →

Google lists links with "optimized anchor text in ... press releases" distributed on other sites as link spam.

— Google Search Central, spam policies

Source: Google Search Central, Spam policies

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Risky vs Safe

Risky

- ✕ Anchor "cheap SEO services Sydney" in every paragraph
- ✕ A release with no news, just for the link
- ✕ A dozen links in one release

Safe

- ✓ Brand name or URL as the anchor
- ✓ News that earns follow-up coverage
- ✓ 1–2 links to a relevant page

Source: Google Search Central, Spam policies

So What Are Release Links Worth?

Three real things: **referral traffic** from readers, **brand mentions** on news sites that help people recognise you, and **follow-up coverage** from journalists who find your release.



rel="sponsored" Is Normal

Google asks for paid or placed links to carry **rel="sponsored"** or **nofollow**. So judge a release by who reads it and who writes about it next, not by "link juice".

Source: Google Search Central, Qualify outbound links

An SEO-Safe Release Checklist

- Keywords appear naturally in the headline, not stuffed
- One main link to a relevant page
- Anchor = brand name or URL
- Data or a quote other media will want to cite
- Track brand mentions, not just link counts

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Good PR Helps SEO. Not the Other Way Round.

1. Save this checklist
2. Send it to your SEO team

Source:
· Google Search Central — Spam policies
· Google Search Central — Qualify outbound links